QUANTITATIVE UX RESEARCH · FEEDBACK-DRIVEN OPTIMIZATION

Turning exit feedback into a 5.8% conversion lift: redesigning Topshop's on-site search

How intercept survey feedback and behavioral analytics were triangulated to find a hidden conversion lever — and how a four-variant experiment turned it into measurable revenue.

ROLE	TEAM	METHODS	OUTCOME
Analyst / Optimization Specialist	Capita · Qubit · Topshop	Exit intercepts · Funnel analysis · A/B/n testing	+5.8% conversion uplift

01 — THE PROBLEM

Numbers tell you the scale of a problem. Feedback tells you how to deal with it.

Topshop's search bar sat on every user's path to purchase — but it was underperforming. We knew *something* was wrong from the behavioral data alone: search adoption was low relative to comparable retailers, and sessions that never touched search converted at a fraction of those that did.

What the quantitative data couldn't tell us was **why**. Was it discoverability? Usability? Result quality? Pushing a sitewide redesign on a guess would have burned IT resources on an unvalidated hypothesis. We needed the user's voice before touching the interface.

02 — THE ANALYSIS

Triangulating intercept feedback with behavioral data

QUALITATIVE SIGNAL — EXIT INTERCEPTS

Using Qubit's Visitor Opinion exit-feedback tool — an on-site intercept survey triggered as users left — we captured open-ended feedback at the moment of abandonment. A recurring theme emerged: **users struggled to both find and use the search bar.** It read as a low-contrast text element with no visual affordance signalling "type here."

QUANTITATIVE SIGNAL — ANALYTICS

Qubit's behavioral analytics quantified the stakes: visitors who used search **converted roughly 10× higher** than those who didn't. Search wasn't a convenience feature — it was the single highest-intent behavior on the site, and friction there was directly suppressing revenue.

> *The intercept feedback gave us the diagnosis; the analytics gave us the business case. Neither alone would have justified the work — together they made it the obvious next test.*

03 — THE DECISION

Test the hypotheses — don't ship the guess

The feedback pointed at two candidate fixes: **visibility** (the field didn't look like an input) and **affordance copy** (the label didn't invite action). Rather than allocating extensive IT resources to push a full sitewide change based on either hypothesis, we designed four search variations testing both dimensions — changes in copy, and the addition of a border to the search box.

The test was split evenly across all users, with the existing design as control, so any winner would carry statistical evidence into the IT prioritization conversation — not opinion.

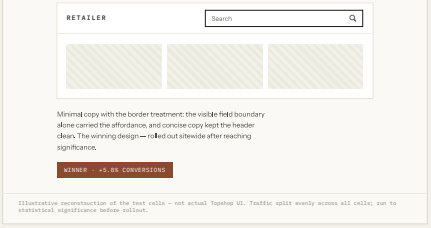
`H1 · Visual affordance → border` `H2 · Invitation → copy change` `H3 · Combined effect`

04 — THE EXECUTION

Four variants, one control, evenly split

Explore the test cells below. Each variant isolates or combines the two hypotheses so the winning treatment could be attributed to a specific mechanism, not just "the new one."

Variant A | Variant B | Variant C | **Variant D**



Minimal copy with the border treatment: the visible field boundary alone carried the affordance, and concise copy kept the header clean. The winning design — rolled out sitewide after reaching significance.

WINNER · +5.8% CONVERSIONS

Illustrative reconstruction of the test cells — not actual Topshop UI. Traffic split evenly across all cells; run to statistical significance before rollout.

05 — THE IMPACT

Evidence, not opinion, went to the roadmap

+5.8%	10×	9–11%
conversion uplift from the winning search design	higher conversion rate for search users — the insight that prioritized the work	cumulative uplift once the same test-first method was applied to product pages

The winning variant shipped sitewide with a quantified business case attached. Just as importantly, the **method** stuck: the same intercept-feedback → hypothesis → controlled-test loop was applied to a series of product-page micro-changes — size selectors, delivery tabs, confirmation pop-ups, add-to-bag buttons — which together added between 9 and 11% uplift in conversion rate, without committing IT resources to anything unproven.

THE GROWTH

What this project taught me

Intercepts earn their place at the moment of intent
Exit-triggered feedback captured the "why" that no funnel chart could. Targeting logic — who sees the survey, when, and how often — determined whether the signal was usable at all.

Triangulation is what makes feedback actionable
Survey verbatims alone are anecdotes; behavioral data alone is a mystery. Joining them turned a vague complaint into a prioritized, sized, testable hypothesis.

Small tests protect big resources
The cheapest experiment that can settle an argument should always run before engineering commits. Evidence travels further with stakeholders than any deck of opinions.